

Belong Field Operations — Recurring Operating System

How the market is run after the 72-hour window closes

The 72-hour plan fixes this week. This fixes the causes. The inherited queue failed in three **structural** ways, not nineteen individual ways: nothing checked whether a visit was **executable** before it was booked, nothing de-duplicated at intake, and no one owned final verification. Every element below exists to close one of those.

1 The workflow, and the gate that closes each stage

A stage is not complete because work happened. It is complete when its gate passes. Two gates were missing entirely and caused most of this week's failures — they are marked.

Stage	Owner	Gate that must pass before the next stage
Intake	Coordinator + tool	Home identified, open queue checked for a duplicate, channel and timestamp recorded. One issue is one case regardless of how many channels it arrives through.
Triage	Coordinator	Priority set against a named policy clause, not a feeling. Containment separated from final repair in writing.
Containment	Coordinator → Field Specialist	Harm stopped and confirmed, or containment explicitly recorded as not required. Containment is never logged as resolution.
Diagnosis	Licensed vendor	A measured onsite finding. No estimate is approval-ready without one, whatever the number or the urgency.
Approval	By amount — see §2	Written scope, cost, and the named authority that approved it. Exceptions record the criteria met.
Dispatch	Coordinator	ACCESS GATE (new): confirmed access, COI filed and receipt confirmed, building or HOA requirement met, licence verified for the trade, parts on hand.
Completion	Vendor	Scope performed with before-and-after evidence and an itemised invoice.
Verification	Named Belong owner (new)	A functional test by Belong or a confirmed Resident check. Vendor completion alone is never verification.
Invoice review	Coordinator → Lead	Invoice matches the approved scope. Any variance is escalated before payment, not after.
Closeout	Coordinator	Warranty and parts recorded, Resident informed, root cause noted if it was a repeat.

2 Decision rights and escalation

Level	Owns	Approves up to	Escalates when
Coordinator	Case ownership, Resident communication, access, scheduling, COIs, vendor booking	Within the Home limit	Safety, a licence question, spend above the limit, or a deadline at risk
Team lead	Priorities within the workstream, coordinator plans, vendor performance, escalations	Emergency containment to \$1,500 (In-Home); Home limits (Readiness)	A signed-move-in exception, vendor probation or removal, cross-workstream conflict
Manager	Priorities across workstreams, exceptions, vendor network, capacity	Signed-move-in exception to \$2,500	Anything above \$2,500, or a change to a commitment made to a Resident on a signed lease

Three triggers escalate on sight, not at the next stand-up: **safety** (any P0), **money** (any spend above the Home limit), and **a promise** (anything threatening a committed move-in). The third is the one teams get wrong: a move-in at risk escalates the day it becomes at risk, not the day it fails.

3 How vendors are selected, scored, coached, restricted and removed

Selected on licence and insurance verified for the specific trade, zone coverage, first-visit resolution, documentation quality, capacity, and a named backup. Never on price alone — the four cheapest vendors in this network are also the four worst at resolving on the first visit, which is where the real cost sits.

Scored monthly on first-visit resolution, on-time arrival, 30-day callback rate, documentation completeness, and invoice variance against the approved quote.

Coached when any measure falls below threshold: a documented conversation, a written expectation, and a 30-day watch. Coaching is recorded, not implied.

Restricted when the watch period fails: no unsupervised licensed work, no committed move-ins, and a capped daily volume until the scores recover.

Removed for two missed appointments on P0 or P1 work, any work performed outside their licence, or completion evidence that does not match what was done.

Structurally no trade may depend on a single vendor. Today the network has one electrician, one plumber covering two zones, and one vendor of any kind in Fort Lauderdale. Those are recruitment targets, not scheduling problems — no dispatcher can solve them on the day.

4 Management cadence

Rhythm	Duration	What it decides, and what it produces
Daily 08:00	15 min	Overnight P0 and P1, vendor holds expiring today with the release time for each, committed move-ins inside 72 hours, capacity conflicts, and any case without an owner. Held at 08:00 because the day's irreversible releases fall between 08:15 and 09:30 — this meeting makes them, it does not report them. Output: a named owner on every case, and the release list with times.
Daily 16:30	15 min	What completed and was verified, not what a vendor said was done. What slipped and the cause rather than the fact. What needs a decision tonight, including any time-bound promise made to a Resident. What the next shift inherits. Held at 16:30 because it is the last point at which every shift still overlaps. Output: nothing open ends the day without an owner and a next action.
Weekly Monday	45 min	The seven measures against target. Vendor scorecards. Every repeat repair with its root cause, not just the fact of the repeat. Every SLA breach with its cause, justified ones included. Coverage and capacity gaps. This is the only meeting permitted to change how the system works — the daily ones run it. Output: vendor decisions (coach, restrict, remove) and any agreed change to the operating rules.
Monthly	60 min	Vendor network composition and redundancy, so no trade sits on a single supplier. Home approval limits tested against what work actually costs. The classification rules and thresholds the triage tool applies. Output: recruitment targets, revised Home limits, and rule changes for the tool.

5 The seven measures I would run the operation on

Measure	Why this one
P0 and P1 qualified arrival within target, %	Safety and the service promise in a single number. Counts qualified arrival, not dispatch.
First-visit resolution, %	The strongest predictor of true cost. A second visit costs more than the cheaper vendor saved.
Repeat repair within 60 days, %	Measures the quality of the fix rather than the speed of the visit. This week's repeat leak was a generalist doing licensed work.
Committed move-ins met without a QC exception, %	The promise that carries the most reputational and financial weight.
Failed-access visits, % of dispatches	Tells you directly whether the access gate is working. Every failed trip is capacity destroyed for free.
Median time to containment, P0 and P1	What the Resident actually experiences. Resolution can wait; harm cannot.
Cost per resolved case, and % of spend above the Home limit	Money with context, and an early signal that limits no longer match reality.

A QC exception is any handover where final verification happened later than four hours before move-in, or where an unresolved life-safety, security, utility, sanitation or required-appliance blocker was accepted. Exceptions are not forbidden — a documented one agreed with the incoming Resident is management. The target is that they stay rare, approved and written down, never silent.

Deliberately excluded: cases closed per day and time-to-first-reply. Both improve by closing cases fast and answering with nothing, which is the behaviour that produced a duplicate pair and an 85-hour-old case in this queue.

6 Where AI acts, where it recommends, and where a human must approve

Acts automatically	Recommends only	Human approval mandatory
Structure the intake and extract Home, trade, access window, COI and deadlines	Priority level and the policy clause it rests on	Any dispatch to an occupied Home
Match against the open queue and flag duplicates and repeats	Vendor ranking	Any spend above the Home limit
Quarantine instructions embedded in third-party text	The containment measure	Every signed-move-in exception
Filter vendors by licence, zone and capacity	The drafted Resident, Homeowner or vendor message	Any change to a commitment already made
Start the SLA clock and flag conflicts against the live board	The next operating action	Anything sent to a Resident or Homeowner

Controls before live use: a human confirmation on every dispatch and every outbound message; an append-only log of the rule that fired, the input it fired on and who approved the outcome; vendor and third-party free text treated as untrusted by default; a weekly review of P0 and P1 classifications against what actually happened; and no interface path — none, not even an override — to assign an unlicensed vendor to licensed work.

One caution learned this week. The supplied data contained five instructions written to be obeyed by an automated reader, three of which pointed at the most expensive available errors. Any tool that reads vendor or building text is a target. That is why the triage engine is deterministic, why it quarantines before it analyses, and why no automated step may change a priority, a licence status or a spend approval on its own.